

conducive to the conditions. They've done it for long enough now. In Adelaide, where the groundsman is from, it can get up to 45 degrees Celsius during the hottest summer, which is quite hot and dry. And then in the winter, it can get down close to 0.

He'll have all the technology and know-how to produce them. When they first started the drop-in wickets, they weren't very good. But year after year, the ground staff and the people involved in it have learned how to ensure they can still get that consistent pace and bounce in. So, I think the ones we will see at the World Cup will be excellent cricket pitches. Something I have heard is that hopefully, at the end of the World Cup, they're going to be donated to USA Cricket in certain parts of the country. It would be great for the grassroots level as well to have ready-made cricket pitches there. We just need someone who knows how to take care of them.

The term "good pitches" is a relative term. What constitutes a good pitch?

A good pitch is an even contest between bat and ball, so there's something in it for everybody. In my experience, drop-in pitches don't spin a great deal, but there's enough there. They can be fast and bouncy. I know the one in Perth at the big Optus Stadium; they say it's one of the fastest in Australia. Adelaide, they say, is quick as well. So, the guys have the formula to produce good cricket pitches.

When you talk about the life expectancy of a pitch, particularly a drop-in pitch, is there a life expectancy where, after a few years, the drop-in pitch is kind of taken out and something else is planted in its place?

I don't think that's the case. They renovate them ever so often, and the renovation should create that growth underneath. I don't know exactly how all that works. But having talked to a few and seen them in action, if they keep renovating and top-dressing, the pitch should survive pretty much

Task cut out: Stuart Law's first assignment with USA will be a T20I series at home against Bangladesh. AFP

